THARIFITH

Riffian Language Course

LESSON 7

Days, Months & Seasons

A Comprehensive Guide for Beginners Created by LEARN THARIFITH

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1. Introduction to Time Expressions

Time is a fundamental aspect of human experience, and the ability to express temporal concepts is essential for meaningful communication in any language. In Tharifith, the vocabulary for days, months, and seasons reflects both traditional Amazigh timekeeping practices and influences from the broader Arabo-Islamic and Mediterranean cultural contexts. Understanding how to express time-related concepts will enable you to make appointments, discuss past and future events, describe seasonal activities, and engage in the temporal dimension of conversation that is so crucial to everyday life.

The traditional Amazigh calendar, known as the agrarian calendar, has its own system for marking time that predates the Islamic and Gregorian calendars. This traditional calendar begins with the agricultural new year, known as Yennayer, which falls on January 12th according to the Gregorian calendar. While modern Riffian speakers use both the Gregorian and Islamic calendars for various purposes, many traditional time expressions and seasonal references remain deeply embedded in everyday speech. Learning these time expressions will provide you not only with practical vocabulary but also with insight into the agricultural cycles and cultural practices that have shaped Riffian society over centuries.

2. Days of the Week

The names of the days in Tharifith show the influence of Arabic on the language, as is common throughout North Africa. The week begins on Sunday in the traditional reckoning, with Saturday marking the end of the work week. Each day has a specific name that is used consistently across Riffian-speaking communities. Learning the days of the week is essential for making appointments, discussing schedules, and understanding references to specific days in conversation. The names are used in both formal and informal contexts, and you will hear them frequently in daily speech when people discuss their plans, work schedules, and social activities.

2.1 The Seven Days

The seven days of the week in Tharifith follow a naming pattern that, like many languages, combines numerical and descriptive elements. The names are: "Rḥed" (Sunday), "Rethnayen" (Monday), "Tratha" (Tuesday), "Rarbaɛ" (Wednesday), "Rekhmis" (Thursday), "Jemɛa" (Friday), and "Ssebt" (Saturday). The word "Jemɛa" // “Jumuɛa” (Friday) is particularly significant as it is the day of congregational prayer in Islam and holds special religious importance. When using these terms in sentences, they typically appear with the preposition "dhi / gi " (in/on) to indicate when something occurs: "dhi Rḥed" / “dhi nhar n Rḥed” / “dhi ass

n Rḥed” all these expressions mean "on Sunday." Understanding these day names will help you navigate weekly schedules and plan activities with Riffian speakers.

English	Tharifith	Tifinagh	Literal « arabic »Meaning
Sunday	**Rḥed / Acer**	ⵔⵃⴷ / ⴰⵙⵉⵔ	the one / first
Monday	**Rethnayen**	ⵔⵜⵏⴰⵢⵏ	the second
Tuesday	**Tratha**	ⵜⵕⴰⵜⴰ	the third
Wednesday	**Rarbaɛ**	ⵔⴰⵔⴱⴰⵄ	the fourth
Thursday	**Rekhmis**	ⵔⴽⵅⵎⵉⵙ	the fifth
Friday	**Jemɛa**	ⵊⵎⵄⴰ	gathering day
Saturday	**Ssebth**	ⵙⵙⴱⵜ	rest day

Table 1: Days of the Week

2.2 Today, Yesterday, and Tomorrow

In addition to the specific day names, Tharifith has essential words for expressing relative time concepts like "today," "yesterday," and "tomorrow." These words are among the most frequently used time expressions in everyday speech. "Ass-a" or "nhar-a" means "today", while "Idhenat" means "yesterday" and "Thiwcha" means "tomorrow." These terms can be combined with verbs to express when actions occur: "Thiwcha ad-yugur/ad-yuyar" means "He will go tomorrow." Understanding these relative time expressions is essential for discussing immediate plans and recent events in conversation.

English	Tharifith	Tifinagh
today	**ass-a / nhar-a**	ⴰⵙⴰ / ⵏⵀⴰⴰ
yesterday	**idhenat**	ⵉⴷⵀⴰⵏⴰⵜ
tomorrow	**thiwcha**	ⵜⵉⵡⵛⴰ
day before yesterday	**Fer-idhenat**	ⴼⵔ ⵉⴷⵀⴰⵏⴰⵜ
day after tomorrow	**Fer-thiwcha**	ⴼⵔ ⵜⵉⵡⵛⴰ

Table 2: Relative Day Expressions

3. Months of the Year

The names of the months in Tharifith reflect the complex history of timekeeping in North Africa, with influences from both the Gregorian calendar used internationally and the traditional Amazigh agricultural calendar. In everyday life, most Riffian speakers use the

Gregorian month names, which are largely derived from Arabic. However, the traditional Amazigh month names are still known and used in certain contexts, particularly in rural areas and in discussions related to agriculture and traditional practices. Understanding both systems will give you a complete picture of how time is conceptualized and expressed in Tharifith-speaking communities.

3.1 Gregorian Months

The Gregorian months used in Tharifith are largely derived from Arabic names, reflecting the historical influence of Arabic on the language. These names are used in official contexts, business, education, and everyday conversation when referring to dates according to the standard calendar. The months are: "Yennayer" (January), "Febrayar" (February), "Mars" (March), "Ibril" (April), "Mayyu" (May), "Yunyu" (June), "Yulyu" (July), "ghucht" or "Aghucht" (August), "Chutambir" (September), "Thubar" (October), "Nwambiṛ" (November), and "Dujambir" (December). Learning these month names is essential for discussing dates, making appointments, and understanding calendars used in Tharifith-speaking regions. But we use often the month number : “ch-ha n wahit” January, “ch-ha n tnayen” February, “ch-ha n thratha” March, “ch-ha n abɛa” April, “ch-ha n khemsa” May, “ch-ha n setta” June, “ch-ha n sebɛa” July, “ch-ha n thmenya” August, “ch-ha n tesɛa” September, “ch-ha n ɛechra” October, “ch-ha n hitach” November, “ch-ha n thenɛach” December.

English	Tharifith	Tifinagh
January	**Yennayer**	ⵉⵏⵏⴰⵢⴻⵔ
February	**Febrayar**	ⴼⴻⴱⵔⴰⵢⴻⵔ
March	**Mars**	ⵎⴰⵕⵚ
April	**Ibril**	ⵉⴱⵔⵉⵍ
May	**Mayyu**	ⵎⴰⵢⵢⵓ
June	**Yunyu**	ⵢⵓⵏⵢⵓ
July	**Yulyu**	ⵢⵓⵍⵢⵓ
August	**ghucht / Aghucht**	ⵖⵓⵛⵜ
September	**Chutambir**	ⵛⵓⵜⴰⵎⴱⵉⵔ
October	**Kthubar**	ⵜⵓⴱⴰⵕ
November	**Nwambiṛ**	ⵏⵡⴰⵎⴱⵉⵔ
December	**Dujambir**	ⴷⵓⵊⴰⵎⴱⵉⵔ

Table 3: Months of the Year

4. Seasons of the Year

The seasons in Tharifith reflect the Mediterranean climate of the Rif region, which is characterized by mild, wet winters and hot, dry summers. The traditional understanding of seasons in Riffian culture is closely tied to agricultural cycles, with each season bringing specific activities and expectations. The vocabulary for seasons is essential for discussing weather, planning activities, and understanding references to seasonal events and agricultural practices. The Rif region experiences four distinct seasons, though the transitions between them can be gradual and the timing can vary from year to year.

4.1 The Four Seasons

The four seasons in Tharifith are: "Thafsuth/ arbiɛ" (spring), "Anebdhu" (summer), "Amwan/ Rekhrif" (autumn), and "Thajresth/ Rmechta" (winter). Each season has distinct characteristics that are reflected in the language used to describe it. Spring (Thafsuth) is associated with new growth, flowers, and the celebration of the Amazigh new year. Summer (Anebdhu) brings heat and harvest time. Autumn (Rekhrif) is characterized by falling leaves and cooling temperatures. Winter (Thajresth / Rmechta) brings rain and cold weather to the Rif mountains. Understanding these seasonal terms will help you discuss weather, agriculture, and seasonal activities throughout the year.

English	Tharifith	Months
spring	**Thafsuth /Arbiɛ**	March - May
summer	**Anebdhu**	June - August
autumn/fall	**Amwan / Rekhrif**	September - November
winter	**Thajresth / Rmechta**	December - February

Table 4: Seasons of the Year

4.2 Seasonal Characteristics

Each season in the Rif region brings characteristic weather patterns and activities. Spring is known for its mild temperatures, blooming wildflowers, and the important celebration of Yennayer (Amazigh New Year). Summer is characterized by hot, dry weather, with temperatures often exceeding 30°C in inland areas, making it the season for harvesting wheat and other crops. Autumn brings cooler temperatures and the beginning of the rainy season, along with the olive harvest, which is crucial to the region's economy. Winter in the Rif can be surprisingly cold, with snow occasionally falling in the mountains and abundant rainfall throughout the region. These seasonal patterns shape the agricultural calendar and cultural activities of Riffian communities.

5. Expressing Dates

Now that you have learned the vocabulary for days, months, and seasons, it is important to understand how to combine these elements to express complete dates. In Tharifith, dates are typically expressed with the day number followed by the month name, similar to the format used in many European languages. The construction for expressing dates typically uses the preposition "dhi" (in/on) before the month or day. Understanding how to ask about and express dates is essential for making appointments, discussing events, and filling out forms in Tharifith-speaking contexts.

5.1 Asking and Answering About Dates

To ask about today's date, you can say "Mech-har nhara zi chha?" (What is today's date?) or simply "Min yaâna Tarikh n nhara?" (What date is it?). To express a specific date, you combine the cardinal number with the month name: "*Number* +dhi +*Month*", example: "15 dhi Yennayer" or " 15 dhi chha n wahit" (on January 15th). When discussing years, you can use "dhi usseggwas n / dhi lâam n" followed by the year number: "di usseggwas n 2024" (in the year of 2024). These constructions allow you to express any date accurately in Tharifith.

English	Tharifith
What is today's date?	**Mech-har nhara zi chha?**
Today is January 15th	**Ass-a 15 dhi Yennayer**
in March	**dhi Mars**
on Monday	**dhi Rethnayen**
in the winter	**dhi Rmechta**
in the year of 2024	**dhi usseggwas n 2024**

Table 5: Date Expressions

6. Practice Exercises

6.1 Day Translation

Translate the following days into Tharifith:

1. Sunday _____
2. Wednesday _____
3. Friday _____
4. today _____
5. tomorrow _____

6.2 Month Translation

Translate the following months into Tharifith:

1. January _____
2. April _____
3. August _____
4. October _____
5. December _____

6.3 Seasons

Write the Tharifith term for each season:

1. spring _____
2. summer _____
3. autumn _____
4. winter _____

6.4 Sentence Translation

Translate the following sentences into Tharifith:

1. Today is Friday. _____
2. I will go tomorrow. _____
3. It is cold in winter. _____
4. My birthday is in June. _____
5. What is today's date? _____

7. Answer Key

6.1 Day Translation

1. January ____ _____
2. April ____ _____
3. August ____ _____
4. October ____ _____
5. December ___ _____

6.2 Seasons

1.

2.

3.

4.

6.4 Sentence Translation

1. Today is Friday. ___ _____
2. I will go tomorrow. ____ _____
3. It is cold in winter. ____ _____
4. My birthday is in June. ____ _____
5. What is today's date? ____ _____

8. Lesson Summary

In this seventh lesson, you have acquired comprehensive vocabulary for expressing temporal concepts in Tharifith. You have learned the names of the seven days of the week, understanding their Arabic-derived forms and literal meanings. You have mastered the twelve months of the year, including both the common names and traditional Amazigh names where applicable. The lesson has also introduced you to the four seasons, with their characteristic weather patterns and cultural significance in the Rif region. Additionally, you have learned relative time expressions like "today," "yesterday," and "tomorrow," which are essential for everyday conversation.

The temporal vocabulary you have learned in this lesson will serve you in countless practical situations, from making appointments and discussing schedules to understanding cultural events and agricultural activities. Remember that time expressions are used with specific prepositions in Tharifith, and dates are expressed by combining numbers with month names using the connector "n" (of). Practice using these expressions in context by describing your weekly schedule, discussing upcoming events, and talking about seasonal activities. In the next lesson, we will explore vocabulary related to food and drinks, which will enable you to discuss meals, order at restaurants, and engage in conversations about culinary traditions in Tharifith-speaking communities.